

A First Latin Reader

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ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

WIKISOURCE

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INTERNET ARCHIVE

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CREATION OF THE EBOOK

The process of building this ebook has been achieved using a toolchain involving the following tools:

- Markdown
- LaTeX
- Pandoc

My work has been based on the following repository on Github:

<https://github.com/jp-fosterson/pandoc-novel>

My thanks go out to the author of this repository. My work would not have been possible without it.

PRAEFATIO

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LATIN-ENGLISH EXERCISES

EARLY AMERICAN HISTORY

Christopher Columbus

Quōdam in oppīdō Ītaliae ōlim nātus est puer, quī Columbus appellābātur. Diū in patris officīnā¹ labōrāvit. Sed prope erat mare, puerque saepe ad lītus ībat, ut vidēret nāvēs, quae ē portū ad terrās exhibant dīversās. In nāvibus erant hominēs multī, et Columbus mare ipse trānsīre saepe voluit; tum autem pecūniam nūllam habēbat. Sed posteā, cum iam iuvenis esset, usque ad² Britanniam et Āfricam nāvīgāvit.

Illīs temporibus³ nautae timēbant mare Atlanticum, cursumque prope lītus tenēbant. Interdum⁴ autem secundum Āfricae ōram⁵ longē nāvīgātum erat⁶, quod Henrīcus, rēx Lūsitāniae, invenīre viam volēbat, quā⁷ nāvēs circum Āfricam prō-

¹officina officina, -ae f., workshop.

²usque ad: all the way to, lit. even to.

³illīs temporibus: in those days.

⁴interdum: not interim.

⁵ōram: i.e. lītus (ōra, -ae f.)

⁶nāvīgātum erat: people had sailed, lit. it has been sailed (impersonal passive).

⁷quā: by which; antecedent, viam

gressae, ad Asiam pervenire possent⁸.

Quīdam⁹ tum crēdebant terram esse rotundam¹⁰, Columbus-que etiam spērāre coeperat se trānsire mare Atlanticum posse, et ita ad Asiam pervenire; nēmō enim intellegēbat terram tam magnam esse, nec¹¹ Columbus ipse suspicātus est Americam interpōnī¹².

Christopher Columbus (Continued)

Interim Henricus rēx mortuus erat. Columbus tamen in Lūsitāniam profectus est, ut rēgī tum ibi rēgnum obtinentī¹³ cōsiliū suū aperīret; sed pecūniam, quam petēbat, dare nōlēbat rēx. Ex Lūsitāniā igitur in Hispāniam iter fēcit Columbus; ubi¹⁴ rēx Ferdinandus Isabellaque bellum cum Maurīs gerēbant, nec quisquam¹⁵ advenam libenter audiēbat. Itaque ille, ubi¹⁶ cōgnōvit rēgem et rēgīnam nōlle ea¹⁷ facere quae spērāverat, ad Galliam versus profectus est; cum autem montēs trānsīret, nūntius est cōsecūtus, qui dīxit velle¹⁸ iam Isabelam parāre nāvēs pecūniamque dare. Quā rē auditā, Columbus laetus¹⁹ rediit, nautāsque validōs quaerere coepit; sed paene omnēs, perīculum veritī²⁰, cum eō nāvigāre nōlēbant.

⁸ **possent**: *could*; subjunctive in a relative clause of purpose. In translating the verb **possum**, some other rendering than "be able" should often be chosen.

⁹ **quīdam**: masc. pl., used as a noun.

¹⁰ **rotundam** : **rotundus**, **-a**, **-um** *round*, or *spherical*

¹¹ **nec**: *and ... not*

¹² **interpōnī**: lit. *to lie between*

¹³ **obtainētī**: pres. part. modifying **rēgī**

¹⁴ **ubi** (*but*) *there*.

¹⁵ **nec quisquam**: *and nobody*.

¹⁶ **ubi** temporal conjunction

¹⁷ **ea**: (neut. pl.) *the things*.

¹⁸ **velle**: *was willing*.

¹⁹ **laetus**: *gladly*, or *with joy*. A Latin adj. is often best translated by an adverb or a phrase.

²⁰ **veritī** perf part. of **vereor**; to be translated as a present, the Latin use

Postrēmō autem ē portū exiit tribus cum nāvibus parvīs, quae Pinta, Nīna, Santaque Marīa appellābantur; cumque paucōs diēs nāvigāset²¹, ad īsulās quāsdam pervēnit, in quibus inveniuntur plūrimae²² avēs, quārum cantus est pulcherrimus. Tum per īgnōtum mare fortiter prōgressus est.

being somewhat inexact.

²¹nāvigāset: *i.e.* nāvigāvisset

²²plūrimae: see *multus*.

CHAPTER

Content

